

Friday, June 19 — Arrive Frankfurt, train to Stuttgart

Big picture: land, clear immigration, walk to the airport's long-distance station, ride ICE 915 to Stuttgart, then family time.

Getting from the plane to your train

1. After landing at Frankfurt (FRA), follow signs to **passport control** (non-EU/"All Passports"). There's no separate customs stop for a normal arrival. Collect checked bags, then look up for the overhead pictogram signs to "**Long-Distance Trains / Fernbahnhof**" — a train symbol, not the regional "S" symbol.
2. The long-distance station (**Frankfurt Flughafen Fernbahnhof**) sits about 200 m from Terminal 1, reached by an enclosed walkway through The Square building. From the arrivals area it's roughly a **10-minute walk**; allow more if you land at Terminal 2 (follow signs / shuttle to T1 first).
3. At the station, find a departure board and look for **ICE 915 to Stuttgart, 10:22**. Note the **Gleis (platform)** — long-distance platforms here are numbered 4–7. Platforms toward Mannheim/Stuttgart are typically 4–5; confirm on the board, not from memory.
4. Go down to your platform. Platform displays show a **car-order diagram (Wagenreihung)** with lettered sections (A–F) — stand in the section where **Coach 28** will stop so you're not sprinting along the train.
5. Board Coach 28, find seats **32 & 33**, store bags on the overhead rack or the end-of-car luggage stack, and settle in. Arrival Stuttgart Hbf **11:33 AM**.

Train: ICE 915 · dep 10:22 AM · arr 11:33 AM · Coach 28, Seats 32 & 33 · 1st class · ticketcode R3LR2LQ5 · lead passenger Lori.

HEADS UP · If your inbound flight is late

Your DB ticket is tied to ICE 915 specifically. If your flight lands so late you'd miss it, the train is one of many that day — go to the **DB Reisezentrum (travel center)** in the station, show your ticket, and ask to be put on the next ICE to Stuttgart. Because this fare is a Super Sparpreis (advance-saver), do this in person rather than just hopping on; keep your ticket and don't discard it.

Once you reach Stuttgart

This night is with family (no hotel is in your Europe Express booking), so the afternoon is yours. Stuttgart Hbf opens right onto the city center. If the family group wants a gentle outing:

- **Relaxed:** Walk Königstrasse (the pedestrian shopping street) to **Schlossplatz**, the grand palace square with fountains and lawns — a flat 30–45 min stroll. Lunch at the **Markthalle**, a 1914 Art-Nouveau market hall a few blocks on, with sit-down stands (Swabian, Italian, tapas).
- **If energy is high:** Add the **Mercedes-Benz Museum** — a ~15 min taxi from the center. Its spiral architecture and 160 vehicles impress even non-car people; elevators between every level. ~€16/adult, plan 2 hrs.

Arrival-day reality check

You'll have been awake a long time across an overnight flight plus a 70-minute train. Don't over-plan. A flat stroll, a real meal, and an early night set you up for the Salzburg travel day tomorrow. Keep your Stuttgart family/lodging address written down separately — it's the one piece not in your booking packet.